The Purchase Order Process

From request to close, step by step, with what each role needs to know.

GREAT CIRCLE SOLAR OPERATIONS
INVENTORY SYSTEM · PURCHASE ORDERS

This guide follows one purchase order from the first request to the day it is closed. Each step says what happens, then lists what each role needs to know at that step. Look for your colour-coded role tag and you can skip the rest.

The journey at a glance

STEP 1 Vendor is approved	**STEP 2** Draft the request	**STEP 3** Submit	**STEP 4** Approve	**STEP 5** Issue the PO
STEP 6 Work done / parts received	**STEP 7** Invoice comes in	**STEP 8** Requisitioner review	**STEP 9** Payment approval	**STEP 10** Payment
STEP 11 Close the PO				

The words you will see on a PO

The status shown in the PO list is one word. A PO moves through these in order:

Draft → Requested → Approved → PO Issued → In Progress → Paid → Closed

Two more can happen at the side: **Rejected** (an approver sent it back) and **Voided** (cancelled by an admin, kept on file). **In Progress** means the PO is issued but the work is not all done and paid; **Paid** means the work is done and the payment status is Paid, but nobody has closed it yet.

Who does what: the roles

Roles are given to each person by an admin (Admin tab → Users). A person can hold several. Some roles can be limited to particular sites, in which case you only see and act on those sites.

TAG IN THIS GUIDE	ROLE NAME IN THE USERS TAB	WHAT THE ROLE IS FOR
Requisitioner	Purchase Rec	Raises purchase requests. **Whoever raised a PO stays its requisitioner**: they confirm the parts or work, review its invoices, and close it. Limited to your assigned sites.
Approver	Purchase Rec Approval	Approves, holds or rejects submitted requests. Can be limited to sites.
PO Issuer	PO Issue	Turns an approved request into a numbered PO and sends it to the vendor. Can be limited to sites.
Vendor Approver	Vendor Approval	Approves or rejects new vendors people have asked for. Company-wide.
Invoice Matching	Invoice Matching	Accounting's first step: adds invoices and matches each to a receipt. Can be limited to sites.
Payment Approval	Payment Approval	The supervisor who approves invoices for payment, in batches. Can be limited to sites.
Payment	Payment	Accounting's last step: pays outside the system, then confirms each invoice paid here. Can be limited to sites.
Admin	Admin	Manages users, vendors, categories and settings. Admin does **not** automatically hold the roles above, but can stand in at a few steps (shown below) and is the only one who can void a PO.
Vendor logon	(set up from the Vendors table)	A vendor's own login. It only sees the Purchase Orders tab and only that vendor's issued POs.

Finding your way around the Purchase Orders tab

- **All POs** is the full list. Use the status filter (it has **Open (not closed)**), the site filter, the From/To date boxes, and the ▾ on each column heading for Excel-style filters. The search box at the top right of the page finds a PO by number or text.
- Buttons beside it show only the work waiting for *you*, depending on your roles: `My POs for Approval`, `My POs to Issue`, `Vendors to Approve`, `My Invoices to Review`, `My Invoices for Payment Approval`, `My Invoices to Pay`.
- A number badge on the `Purchase Orders` tab and on those buttons counts what is waiting on you.
- Click a PO to open it. `← Back to Purchase Orders` returns to the list. `View Activity` at the bottom of a PO shows who did what and when.

DATES, MONEY AND NUMBERS
Dates are always yyyy/mm/dd and times are 24-hour. Money always has commas ($1,234.50). A PO number looks like `PO-03-26-007` : the site's code, the year, then a running number for that site and year.

1 The vendor has to be approved

Requisitioner asks **Vendor Approver** decides

A request can be drafted for any vendor, but it cannot be **approved**, and its PO cannot be **issued**, until its vendor is approved. Check the vendor first so nothing stalls later.

Requisitioner

- Pick the vendor from the **Vendor** list on the request form. If it is not there, press `+ New vendor` (the form also checks for a similar vendor that already exists, and offers to use it).
- A new vendor needs approval. You can pick it on your request straight away; the request just waits.
- A vendor that has been **deactivated** by an admin cannot be used on new requests. Choose another, or ask an admin to reactivate it. Its existing POs carry on.

Vendor Approver

- Open `Vendors to Approve`, or use the `Approve vendor` / `Reject vendor` buttons on the warning that appears at the top of a PO whose vendor is pending.
- Rejecting needs a reason, which the requisitioner sees.
- A vendor requested by someone who already holds Vendor Approval is approved automatically.

Admin

Deactivate and reactivate vendors, and manage a vendor's own logon, in Admin → Vendors. Deactivating also switches off the vendor's login.

2 Draft the purchase request Draft

Requisitioner does this step

Raising a request from a ticket does the same thing with some fields pre-filled (see the Ticketing guide)

On the Purchase Orders tab press `+ New Request`. You can only raise requests for the sites you are assigned to; if you try another site you will see *"You can only create purchase requests for the sites you're assigned to."*

The header

FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER
Project *	Regular O&M, Repower - Phase 1 or Repower - Phase 2. Choose it first: it filters the Site and Budget Category lists, and it sets the invoice email.
Site	The solar site company the money belongs to.
Vendor	See step 1.
Location	Only appears for sites that have separate locations (for example Firelight Solar's rooftops), and is then required. A site that has just one location named after itself never asks.
Description	A short summary shown in the PO list, e.g. "Inverter fans for Site 4".
Notes	Anything the approver should know.
Budget Category *	Required. Also pick a **Sub-Category** if there is one. The Budget tab reports spending against these.
Vendor Quote #	The vendor's own quote number, if there is one.
Chargeable Expense	A Yes/No tick that is printed on the PO. Tick it if the expense is chargeable.
Send Invoices To	Set by the project; you cannot change it here. It is printed on the PO so the vendor knows where to send the invoice.
Quote File	Attach the vendor's quote as a PDF. The page reads it and offers what it found (vendor, quote number, lines, tax, shipping). Tick what you want and press apply: **nothing you already typed is overwritten without your say-so**. A scanned picture has no text to read, so type those by hand.
Sales Tax %, Markup %, Shipping/Handling, Credit	Feed the totals. Markup and shipping only appear when the request has part lines.
Currency	The PO's currency. Budget reporting counts non-CAD POs at face value (no exchange rate).
Pre-paid	Only for requests with parts. Tick it if the vendor is paid up front, so there will be no receipt. See the pre-paid note in step 7.
Not to Exceed / Spending Cap	Only for requests with service lines. The PO commits up to the cap rather than the line total, and invoices are compared to the cap.

Line items

Add rows with `+ Add Part` and `+ Add Service`. One request can hold both. Each row has a quantity and unit cost.

- **Service line:** a description of the work.
- **Part line:** you must say what happens to it in inventory. The options are:
  - **Spare**: a part from the site's inventory list. When it is received it is **added to stock**.
  - **Used immediately**: also a listed part, but it goes straight into a job and is never added to stock.
  - **Consumable**: not tracked in inventory (free text). Each unit is capped at a dollar limit an admin sets, shown on the line. A part dearer than the cap has to be a real inventory part or go in a service line.

  Spare and Used parts are searched by GCS P/N, Part ID, manufacturer P/N or description, and can only be parts on **that site's Required Inventory list**. To order a part the site does not list, an inventory editor adds it to the list first.

Saving

Press `Save Draft`. The required items are the Project, Site, Vendor, Budget Category, at least one line, and a Location where the site has locations. The ones you missed are outlined in red. A draft carries a **DRAFT** watermark on its printed view. A draft can be edited with `Edit Draft` and deleted by someone who can raise requests; **only drafts can be deleted**. Anything later is voided instead.

> **CHECK BEFORE YOU SAVE**
> A part line left without a choice, a consumable over its limit, or a spare that is not on the site's list will stop the save and be highlighted. Fix the highlighted line and save again.

3 Submit for approval Requested

Requisitioner does this step

Requisitioner

- Open the draft and press `Submit`. It becomes **Requested**. Nothing goes to the vendor yet.
- You can still change it with `Edit Request` while it is Requested (only you or an admin). This is how you fix something an approver put on hold for.
- If you hold Purchase Rec but have no permission for that site, Submit is disabled and says so.

4 Approval Approved

Approver does this step **Requisitioner** waits, then may need to fix

Requests waiting for you are under `My POs for Approval`. Open one to review it. `View PO` shows it laid out as the finished PO, with markup, tax and total, so you can see exactly what you are signing.

Approver

- `Approve`: the request becomes **Approved** and your name and the date go on the PO. Add your signature once under `My Signature` in the page header so it prints on every PO you approve.
- `Hold`: parks it, with an optional reason. It is still Requested but marked on hold, so the requisitioner can fix it. Use `Resume` to bring it back.
- `Reject`: needs a reason, which the requisitioner sees. The request becomes **Rejected**.
- You can only act on requests for the sites you are approving for. You can approve a request you raised yourself.
- Approval is blocked while the vendor is pending, rejected or deactivated, and for any part line that uses an old option that no longer exists (it asks the requisitioner to choose Spare, Used immediately or Consumable).

Requisitioner

- **Waiting on an approver** is shown while it is Requested. An on-hold request says **On hold**; edit it and the approver can resume it.
- If it is **Rejected**, read the reason, press `Return to Draft`, fix it and submit again. Only you (the person who submitted it) or an admin can do this.

5 Issue the PO and tell the vendor PO Issued

PO Issuer does this step

Approved requests waiting to be turned into POs are under `My POs to Issue`.

PO Issuer

1. Open the approved request and press `Issue PO`. The page works out the next PO number (for example `PO-03-26-007`) and asks *Assign PO number …?*
2. Press `Confirm PO`. The request becomes **PO Issued**. It is blocked if the vendor is not approved.
3. Send it to the vendor. `Print PO` and `Download PDF` make the document. `Email Vendor` downloads a ready-to-send email draft (with the PDF) addressed to the vendor, with the site in the subject. It is only offered once the PO has a number and the vendor has an email on file.
4. The PO then shows who has told the vendor: a green **Vendor contacted** (with who, when, and how) or an amber **Not contacted**. Pressing `Email Vendor` sets it the first time. If you called or emailed from your own mail, press `Mark vendor contacted`. `Clear contacted` undoes it.

The printed PO has the same layout for every site: the header lists the Project, Site, Location and Requisitioner, the line items, the approver's signature and the invoice email address.

Requisitioner

From here the PO is yours to track. You will confirm the parts or work in step 6, review invoices in step 8, and close it in step 11.

Vendor logon

If the vendor has a login, they see this PO (and only their own issued POs) under Purchase Orders.

6 The work is done or the parts arrive In Progress

Requisitioner does this step **Vendor logon** can add a service report **Inventory** sees the stock change

This is where the real world catches up with the paperwork. On an issued PO the requisitioner sets the **status** of the parts or the services. These are plain dropdowns; no evidence file is required to change them.

PO HAS	THE DROPDOWN	CHOICES
Parts	**Parts Status** (shown as **PO Status** if the PO is parts only)	Not Ordered → Ordered → Partially Received → Received (and Pre-paid on a pre-paid PO)
Services	**Service Status**	Not Started → Partially Complete → Complete

Requisitioner

- Only **you**, the person who raised the PO, can change these, and only while the PO is issued.
- Add proof under **Receipts & Invoices** → **Add Receipt**: a photo or PDF of what arrived (a parts photo, or a service report for work). Accounting can add receipts too.
- **When you set Parts Status to Received** and the PO has spare parts, a box asks *where the units are*. Choose Oshawa, Barn, Office, or the site's own shelf (if the site keeps parts on a shelf) and press `Mark Received`. The spare units are added to that site's count at the place you chose. There is no default: `Mark Received` stays off until you choose.
- Setting Received only adds the units the **first** time. Used-immediately parts, consumables and services never add to stock.
- If some of the order arrived, use **Partially Received** and set Received when the last of it is in. Stock is added once, at Received, for the whole PO.

Inventory

Until the PO is received, its spare units show in **yellow** on Ownership and Physical Location as "on order". They are real stock only once the requisitioner marks the parts Received. Matching an invoice does not change stock. See the Inventory guide.

Vendor logon

On a services-only PO the vendor can upload their own service report as the receipt. They cannot do that for parts, which only your side can receive.

PRE-PAID WITH SPARE PARTS

A pre-paid PO shows Parts Status **Pre-paid**. If it has spare parts you still have to set **Received** before it can be closed, because that is what adds them to stock. A pre-paid PO with only consumables, used-immediately parts or services can be closed from Pre-paid.

7 The invoice comes in

Invoice Matching does this step **Admin** can too

Open the PO and find **Receipts & Invoices**. It is one table with a row per receipt and invoice and the columns *Receipt, Invoice, Requisitioner Review, Payment Approval, Paid*. The stages of an invoice are:

Needs a receipt matched → **With the requisitioner** → **Waiting on payment approval** → **Approved, ready to pay** → **Paid** (or **Sent back to accounting**)

Invoice Matching

1. Press **Add Invoice (PDF)** and choose the vendor's invoice. The page **reads it**: the invoice number and amount are filled in (you can correct them) and a checklist compares it to the PO (vendor, PO number, total or cap, currency, subtotal, tax, shipping and line items). The PO is shown beside the invoice with disagreeing figures boxed. **It warns but never blocks.** A scanned PDF has no text, so type those in.
2. **Same invoice twice:** the same vendor cannot have the same invoice number twice (case and punctuation ignored). If it really is a separate invoice, write why in *This is a separate invoice, because…* (at least five characters). The same vendor and amount in the last 90 days only gives a warning.
3. **More than the PO:** if the total of invoices would pass the PO total (or the cap), the box *This invoice is for more than the PO* is ticked for you; add a note about the extra. Flagging forces the requisitioner to void and regenerate the PO (step 8). You can clear a wrong flag while the invoice is waiting for review.
4. Press `Add Invoice` (or `Add Invoice & Match` when added to a receipt).
5. **Match it to a receipt.** In the Invoice cell choose *Match to existing receipt…* (or in a receipt's row *Match to existing invoice…*). A small ▲/▼ chip shows whether the invoiced total is over or under the PO.

- An invoice **sent back** by an approver comes back to you. Fix what was wrong and press `Resubmit`, or delete it and upload a corrected one (`Del. Invoice`).
- You can also mark a parts PO **Pre-paid** (a toggle in this panel) if that was missed on the request.

Requisitioner

If the parts are in, make sure you have added the receipt. Without a matched receipt the invoice waits at "Needs a receipt matched".

PRE-PAID POS

Because there is no receipt, an invoice on a pre-paid PO skips matching and goes straight to the requisitioner's review.

ONLY ISSUED POS

Invoice lists only include issued or closed POs. An invoice sitting on a regenerated draft waits until that draft is issued.

8 The requisitioner reviews the invoice

Requisitioner does this step **Admin** can stand in

Invoices waiting for you are under `My Invoices to Review` (and in the PO's own table). You are confirming that the invoice matches what you actually received.

Requisitioner

- `Approve`: it moves on to payment approval. You can **Undo** that while the supervisor has not acted on it.
- `Hold`: pause it with a reason (required) while you check something. You cannot approve a held invoice until you press `Release`. Held invoices do not count in the badges.
- `Send Back`: returns it to accounting with a reason (required), clearing any hold.
- **If accounting flagged it "Over the PO":** there is **no Approve, no Hold and no Send Back**. The only button is `Void & regenerate PO`. It copies the PO as a new **draft** (same site, vendor, lines, category, ticket link), voids the original with the reason, moves the invoices and receipts onto the draft, and opens the draft with a banner showing the invoice amount against the draft's live total. Raise the prices until the banner shows ✓, then save and submit it again (step 3). It is only possible if the PO's parts were not received and no other invoice on it is approved or paid. The two POs are linked under **Related POs**. Only accounting or an admin clearing the flag frees the invoice otherwise.

The message "*Only the person who raised this PO can review its invoices.*" means you are not that person.

9 Approval for payment (in batches)

Payment Approval does this step

Open `My Invoices for Payment Approval`. Each row shows its PO, vendor, invoice and amount, with a total of what is pending.

Payment Approval

- **Tick** the invoices you approve and press the approve button. You can name the batch (the box suggests *Approved invoice batch yyyy/mm/dd*) or leave it blank. Each approval is recorded as a **batch**: your name, the time and the list. An invoice approved one at a time from a PO's page is a batch of one. **Recent payment batches** at the bottom shows how many in each have been paid.
- `Hold` (reason required) pauses an invoice while it waits, or after you approved it but before it is paid. Held invoices cannot be ticked into a batch until released. `Release` restores it.
- `Send Back` (reason required) returns it to accounting. A flagged "over the PO" invoice never reaches you; it goes back through the requisitioner.
- You can take back an approval (**Undo**) while the invoice is not yet paid.

10 Pay, then confirm it here Paid

Payment does this step

The system does **not** send money. You pay by your own means (EFT, cheque), then record it.

Payment

1. Open `My Invoices to Pay`. Filter by batch if you like (it shows "x of y paid"), and `Download List (CSV)` for your own records.
2. After paying an invoice, set the **date paid** and optionally a **reference** (cheque, EFT or transaction number), then press `Confirm Paid`. The same box is on the PO's Receipts & Invoices table. **Clear** reverses it.
3. A held invoice cannot be marked paid until the supervisor releases it.
4. When every invoice on a PO is paid, set the PO's **Payment Status** dropdown to **Paid**. (It is also available as Unpaid or Partially Paid. It refuses Paid until every invoice is marked paid.)

11 Close the PO Closed

Requisitioner does this step

The `Close PO` button appears for the requisitioner only when **all** of these are true:

- The PO is issued, and every part is **Received** and every service **Complete** (a pre-paid PO can stand on Pre-paid, unless it has spare parts).
- Payment Status is **Paid**.
- There is at least one invoice, every invoice is approved and paid, and every receipt is matched to an invoice (a pre-paid PO needs only the invoices approved and paid).

The labels alone are not enough: someone cannot close a PO that is still marked Unpaid in the paperwork. Press `Close PO` and it becomes **Closed**. On the **Budget** tab a closed PO stops counting what is "to be invoiced".

After the PO and in special cases

Voiding a PO

Admin

A PO past Draft is never deleted: an admin **voids** it, with a reason, and it stays on file. You cannot void a PO if its parts were already received, an invoice on it is paid or approved for payment, or it is closed. Reverse those first (an inventory adjustment for received stock, withdraw the approval, clear the payment). A voided PO keeps a read-only list of its receipts and invoices so the files can still be opened.

Related POs

Open a PO and look under **Related POs**. POs from the same vendor that share an invoice number or invoice file appear automatically. People with a PO role can also link two POs by hand by typing the other PO's number ("*There is no PO numbered …*", "*A PO can't be linked to itself.*" and "*Those two POs are already linked.*" are the refusals).

Linking a PO to a ticket

A PO can carry a link to a ticket so each can find the other. See the Ticketing guide. The number must look like `TK-06-26-001`.

Who can see history and money reports

- **PO History** tab (admin, Invoice Matching, Payment Approval, Payment, Purchase Rec Approval and PO Issue): a tamper-proof record of every change, who made it and when, with filters and a CSV export.
- **Budget** tab (admin and the three accounting roles): each site's budget against issued POs, approved invoices and what is still to be invoiced, by category. Only an admin edits the budget numbers.

Quick reference by role

What each role is responsible for, in one place.

ROLE	STEPS	YOUR LISTS	REMEMBER
Requisitioner	2, 3, 4 (fix), 6, 8, 11	All POs, My Invoices to Review	You stay responsible for a PO you raised: receive it, review its invoices, close it. Only you (or an admin) can.
Approver	4	My POs for Approval	Approve, hold or reject. Rejecting needs a reason. Blocked if the vendor is not approved.
PO Issuer	5	My POs to Issue	Confirm the PO number, send the PO, mark the vendor contacted.
Vendor Approver	1	Vendors to Approve	A pending vendor blocks approval and issue.
Invoice Matching	7	Receipts & Invoices on each PO	Add the invoice, check the comparison, flag "over the PO", match it to a receipt.
Payment Approval	9	My Invoices for Payment Approval	Approve in batches. Hold or send back with a reason.
Payment	10	My Invoices to Pay	Pay outside the system, then Confirm Paid with the date and a reference.
Admin	Any (stand-in), voiding	All, plus the Admin tab	Admin does not get the PO roles automatically. Voids POs; can stand in as requisitioner for invoice review.
Vendor logon	5, 6	Own issued POs	Sees only that vendor's issued POs; can add a service report on a services-only PO.

When something is blocked

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS / WHAT TO DO
"*… is still pending approval as a vendor.*"	A Vendor Approver has to approve the vendor first.
"*… has been deactivated as a vendor — choose another vendor, or ask an admin to reactivate it.*"	The vendor can't take new work.
"*A reason is required to reject a request.*" (also for voiding, holding an invoice, sending an invoice back)	Type a reason in the box that pops up.
"*Only the person who raised this PO can review its invoices.*"	Ask the requisitioner, or an admin.
"*An invoice on hold can't be approved — release it first.*"	Press Release, or ask the person who held it.
"*This invoice is for more than the PO: void the PO and regenerate it at the new amount instead.*"	Use Void & regenerate PO, or ask accounting to clear a wrong flag.
"*Every invoice must be marked paid first.*"	Payment Status can't be Paid until each invoice is confirmed paid.
"*Only a draft can be deleted — void the PO instead, which keeps it on file.*"	Ask an admin to void it.
Close PO button is missing	Check, in this order: parts Received / services Complete, Payment Status Paid, every invoice approved and paid, every receipt matched. For a pre-paid PO with spare parts, Received must be set.
Invoice duplicate message	The vendor already has that invoice number. Explain why it is separate, or it is probably a duplicate.

The other guides: Inventory Guide · Ticketing Guide

Written from how the system works in November 2026. If a button or message differs from this guide, the screen is right: tell an admin.